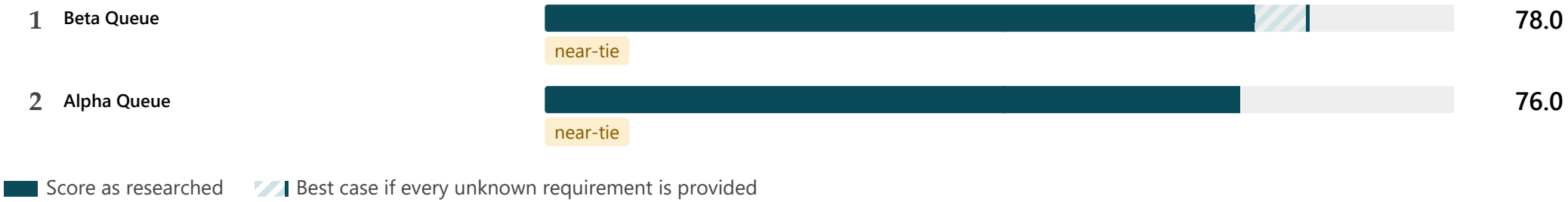
Background task queue

Beta Queue scores 78.0 of 100, 2.0 ahead of Alpha Queue.

The ranking is not settled: the lead is inside the near-tie margin.



Evaluation date 2026-10-01. Scale 0 to 5. Cost mode: weighted.

Decision recommendation

The choice between Beta Queue and Alpha Queue is not clear-cut: Beta Queue scores 78.0 against 76.0 for Alpha Queue, inside the 3-point tie margin. Beta Queue leads on core capabilities, but its operability claims are unverified, and lowering those low-confidence scores puts Alpha Queue ahead. Verify Beta Queue's metrics support before committing.

Confidence: low. A near-tie that flips when low-confidence scores are lowered, with the leader's best case 6 points higher if its unverified claims hold.

Decision table

2 options ranked

Rank	Option	Score	Gates	Low-confidence criteria	Main strength	Main gap
1	Beta Queue	78.0	F-01 pass	1	Strongest core queueing capabilities	Operability claims rest on vendor statements
2	Alpha Queue	76.0	F-01 pass		Well-documented operations, independent sources	Weaker core throughput features

Near-tie (within 3.0 points): Beta Queue, Alpha Queue; broken by higher score on highest-weight criterion.

Scores, gaps and best case

Rank	Option	Weighted score (of 100)	Low-confidence criteria	Must-have gaps	Unknown requirements	Best case if unknowns are provided
1	**Beta Queue** (near-tie)	78.0	1	1	0	84.0
2	**Alpha Queue** (near-tie)	76.0	0	1	0	76.0

Near-tie between Beta Queue, Alpha Queue; broken by higher score on highest-weight criterion.

Context

A small team needs a queue for background jobs (emails, report generation) in an existing web application. The decision is which queue product to adopt. This is a fictional sample evaluation used to test the eval skills.

Criteria and weights

3 criteria

Criterion	Weight	Requirements
Core capabilities	50	F-01, F-02
Operability	30	N-01, N-02
Cost	20	C-01, C-02

Weighted score matrix

3 criteria, 2 options

Contribution of a criterion = score / 5 × weight. † capped for weak evidence.
Confidence: high = two sources, medium = one, low = none.

Criterion	Weight	Beta Queue	Alpha Queue
Core capabilities	50	5 high	4 high

Criterion	Weight	Beta Queue	Alpha Queue
Operability	30	2† low	4 medium
Cost	20	4 medium	3 medium
Weighted total	**100**	**78.0**	**76.0**

† score capped because the evidence is unverified. Confidence: high = two sources, medium = one, low = none. Independent sources count, and the vendor's official documentation counts once for what a product provides.

Bias and assumptions

- Providers were not recorded, so concentration could not be checked.
- Requirements based on an assumption: none.
- Findings by source kind: Alpha Queue 1 vendor, 4 independent or open-source docs; Beta Queue 1 vendor, 3 independent or open-source docs.
- Cost comparison covers 2 of 2 options with a complete price.

This is a fictional sample evaluation with two profiled options; providers were not recorded.

Computed checks

- No requirement is marked as an assumption.
- Findings by source: Alpha Queue: 1 vendor, 4 independent or open source; Beta Queue: 1 vendor, 3 independent or open source.

- Cost compares 2 of 2 options; the others have no published price.

Cost

USD over 36 months

Currency USD, horizon 36 months. Assumptions: Jobs per month 5,000,000 jobs/month; Developers 4 people.

Both options have a complete price, so cost can be compared directly; see the table above.

Over 36 months, in USD. Prices come from the sources listed below; components marked unverified rest on weak evidence, and components marked assumed are placeholders, not published prices.

Assumption	Value	Unit	Scales in scenarios
Jobs per month	5,000,000	jobs/month	yes
Developers	4	people	no

Option	Monthly	One-time	Total over horizon	Vs cheapest	Notes
Beta Queue	380.00	2,000.00	15,680.00	1.00x	unverified: b-plugin
Alpha Queue	1,260.00	0.00	45,360.00	2.89x	

Volume scenarios

Scenario	Beta Queue	Alpha Queue	Cheapest
pilot (100k jobs/month)	15,680.00	3,600.00	Alpha Queue
growth (10M jobs/month)	15,680.00	81,360.00	Beta Queue

Components

Option	Component	Monthly	One-time	Evidence
Beta Queue	Hosting (2 nodes)	300.00	0.00	
Beta Queue	Monitoring plugin	80.00	0.00	unverified
Beta Queue	Initial setup	0.00	2,000.00	
Alpha Queue	Job volume	1,160.00	0.00	
Alpha Queue	Support plan	100.00	0.00	

Feature-by-feature comparison

6 requirements in 3 groups

The full table, with notes and evidence ids in every cell, is in `eval/features.md` and in the exported report. Must-have summary:

Core

provided: Beta Queue 2/2, Alpha Queue 1/2

ID	Requirement	Priority	Beta Queue	Alpha Queue
F-01	At-least-once delivery of jobs	must	provided E-006	provided E-001
F-02	Delayed and scheduled jobs	should	provided E-007	partial no recurring schedules E-002

Operations

provided: Beta Queue 1/2, Alpha Queue 1/2

ID	Requirement	Priority	Beta Queue	Alpha Queue
N-01	Metrics and health endpoints for monitoring	must	partial via plugin, vendor claim only E-008	provided E-003
N-02	Web dashboard for inspecting jobs	could	provided E-008	not provided no dashboard found

Cost

provided: Beta Queue 1/2, Alpha Queue 1/2

ID	Requirement	Priority	Beta Queue	Alpha Queue
C-01	Predictable pricing at 5 million jobs per month	must	provided self-hosted E-009	partial tiered, volume discount E-004
C-02	A usable free tier for development	should	partial no hosted free tier	provided 100k jobs free E-005

Sensitivity

top option holds in all 6 tests

Moving each of the highest weights by 5 points never changes the top option. Lowering low-confidence scores changes the top option in 2 test(s).

Moving the top weights by 5 points never changes the leader; lowering low-confidence scores does, which is why confidence is low.

Each of the highest-weight criteria moved by 5 points, other weights rescaled.

Criterion	Change	Top option	Top changed	Beta Queue	Alpha Queue
Core capabilities	+5	Beta Queue	no	80.2	76.4
Core capabilities	-5	Beta Queue	no	75.8	75.6

Criterion	Change	Top option	Top changed	Beta Queue	Alpha Queue
Operability	+5	Beta Queue	no	75.3	76.3
Operability	-5	Beta Queue	no	80.7	75.7
Cost	+5	Beta Queue	no	78.1	75.0
Cost	-5	Beta Queue	no	77.9	77.0

Confidence tests

Test	Top option	Top changed
all low-confidence scores lowered by one	Alpha Queue	yes
Beta Queue / Operability lowered by one	Alpha Queue	yes

Recommended next steps

1. Verify Beta Queue's metrics support with a short proof of concept (E-008).
2. Ask the Beta vendor for independent operability evidence before committing.

Risks and open questions

- Beta Queue's operability claims are vendor-only and unverified.

- The near-tie means a small change in weights or evidence can reverse the order.

Excluded options

1 options

Gamma Queue fails the at-least-once delivery gate (E-010), so it is not ranked.

Option	Reason
Gamma Queue	Fails F-01: no at-least-once delivery (E-010)

Sources

10 findings

Every finding, with its source, source date, gathered date and label.

ID	Option	Requirement	Finding	Source	Source date	Confidence	Kind
E-001	Alpha Queue	F-01	Delivers at least once under failure injection	bench.example.org	2026-08-01	CONFIRMED	independent
E-002	Alpha Queue	F-02	Delayed jobs supported, recurring schedules are not	review.example.net	2026-07-15	PROBABLE	independent
E-003	Alpha Queue	N-01	Exposes Prometheus metrics and a health endpoint	review.example.net	2026-07-15	PROBABLE	independent
E-004	Alpha Queue	C-01	Tiered pricing with a volume discount above 1M jobs	alpha.example.com	2026-09-01	PRIMARY	vendor
E-005	Alpha Queue	C-02	Free tier of 100k jobs per month	bench.example.org	2026-08-01	PROBABLE	independent
E-006	Beta Queue	F-01	At-least-once delivery confirmed in tests	bench.example.org	2026-08-01	CONFIRMED	independent

ID	Option	Requirement	Finding	Source	Source date	Confidence	Kind
E-007	Beta Queue	F-02	Delayed and recurring jobs supported	docs-mirror.example.net	2026-06-20	PROBABLE	independent
E-008	Beta Queue	N-01	Vendor says metrics are available through a plugin	beta.example.com	2026-09-10	UNVERIFIED	vendor
E-009	Beta Queue	C-01	Open source; hosting cost is predictable	review.example.net	2026-07-15	PROBABLE	independent
E-010	Gamma Queue	F-01	At-most-once delivery only	bench.example.org	2026-08-01	CONFIRMED	independent